

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Team Building: scaled multiple engineering organizations from 2 to 30 engineers

Strategic Vision: Transformed legacy apps into resilient hybrid-cloud architectures for Fortune 100 clients

Client Relationships: Grew key accounts from proof-of-concept to multi-million-dollar engagements

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LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure, GCP, AWS serverless architectures

Data & Analytics: AI/ML platforms, data warehousing, business intelligence

Software Development: Microservices, API-driven development, DevOps mindset, Agile methods

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science
specialization in data science
University of Illinois

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, with honors
University of Alabama

Dual major: MIS, Philosophy
Minors: Computer Science,
Honors Research

RJ Cantrell

Technology executive with 10+ years of leadership experience driving digital transformation and building high-performance engineering teams across fintech, retail, and enterprise software. Proven track record of scaling technical organizations, leading cloud migrations, and delivering AI/ML solutions that directly impact revenue. Combines strategic vision with deep technical expertise to align technology initiatives with business objectives.

EXPERIENCE

DIRECTOR OF SOFTWARE ENGINEERING, NEXEE

Jan 2026 – present

Boulder, CO

- Lead teams across multiple locations in sprint delivery, increasing completion from 31% to consistently 75+%
- Drive cross-functional process improvements across engineering, design, and QA that measurably increased team throughput and reduced defects
- Run the DevOps playbook to continually elevate our constraint
- Design customer-facing ML analytics engine enabling project delivery forecasting, giving probabilistic visibility into sprint outcomes
- Build internal ML-driven log analysis system to proactively detect anomalies and analyze usage patterns, improving platform reliability and informing product decisions

VICE PRESIDENT OF AI SOLUTIONS, BREAKFALL TECHNOLOGIES

Sep 2022 – Dec 2025

Denver, CO

- Led strategic AI initiative for Fortune 100 retail client, delivering advanced market-level sales forecasting solutions to drive pricing strategy and optimize vendor relationships in omni-channel retail
- Spearheaded hybrid cloud migration strategy for multi-location enterprise, resulting in improved scalability while maintaining business continuity
- Designed serverless AI platform to streamline inventory management processes for B2B startup serving small businesses
- Established MLOps pipeline on GCP, reducing model update cycles from weeks to hours and enhancing forecasting reliability

DIRECTOR OF SOFTWARE DELIVERY, WINESHIPPING

Nov 2021 – Sep 2022

Napa, CA (remote)

- Led global technology organization with distributed teams across US, India, and Ukraine
- Drove post-acquisition technology integration strategy, successfully unifying disparate systems and creating a consolidated data ecosystem in Azure
- Transformed legacy monolith into microservice platform, significantly lowering operational costs while enabling rapid feature delivery

- Championed customer-centric design approach, resulting in streamlined order capture and tracking experience for clients representing 50% of the industry's market share
- Established technology roadmap for data analytics products leveraging shipping manifests to provide unique consumer behavior insights to wine industry partners

DIRECTOR OF TECHNOLOGY, KIN + CARTA (now Valtech) Apr 2019 - Nov 2021 Denver, CO

- Grew strategic account from single proof-of-concept to company's largest revenue generator, expanding from two-person team to four cross-functional product teams
- Built and led high-performing technology teams for mission-critical applications in heavily regulated industries, including utilities and oil/gas pipeline operations
- Established technical hiring strategy and standards, personally evaluating and onboarding 20% of agency's technical talent
- Delivered enterprise data platform driving operational efficiency for utilities client, contributing to successful acquisition by industry leader
- Managed P&L responsibility for largest client account, consistently exceeding gross margin targets while maintaining exceptional client-satisfaction metrics

TECHNICAL TEAM LEAD, SUNTRUST BANKS (now Truist) Feb 2014 - Mar 2019 Atlanta, GA

- Led digital transformation initiatives for legacy banking systems, establishing modern development practices within traditional financial institution, significantly reducing lead-time and defect rate
- Architected service-oriented platform that enabled rapid product development and improved time-to-market for banking products
- Developed and implemented engineering excellence program, elevating code quality standards across multiple development teams

TEAM LEAD, KABBAGE (acquired by American Express) Mar 2012 – Jan 2014 Atlanta, GA

- Architected ML-powered credit underwriting engine that became the core of Kabbage's lending platform, allowing us to lend to underserved communities without relying on credit score
- Led development of scalable data integration platform connecting to 15+ APIs (Amazon, eBay, QuickBooks, social media), creating unique alternative data assets for risk assessment
- Partnered with CIO to develop technical roadmap and vendor strategy
- Established cloud infrastructure strategy and tooling to dramatically reduce operational costs despite increased transaction volume and headcount
- Built and mentored cross-functional product delivery team, implementing agile methodologies that improved DORA metrics and employee satisfaction

EARLY CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Led enterprise application modernization for Fortune 500 clients across retail, telecom, government, logistics and financial services sectors
- Pioneered mobile application development for retail inventory management system, incorporating direct store-level user feedback
- Architected conversion of mission-critical application supporting billions in revenue from legacy C++ to modern architecture
- Developed early AI/ML implementations for logistics optimization at major telecom provider

CONSULTING LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

- Managed distributed teams for client engagements at Avanade, a Microsoft/Accenture joint venture
- Served as technical relationship manager for public sector contracts, balancing government requirements with delivery constraints

NOTABLE ACHIEVEMENTS

- Implemented computer-vision system delivering \$2.5 million annual savings for manufacturing operations
- Designed custom mobile device platform for field operations on >100,000 devices
- Created user analytics framework capturing behavioral insights that informed product strategy
- Regularly delivered technical presentations and demonstrations to C-suite stakeholders